

7. Would you obey the quack's advice if you were Birsa?
8. Is the tradition of sacrificing animals to Gods or Goddesses good ? What did Birsa do to check this superstition ?
9. Birsa told people not to follow this type of superstition. Did people like it ? How do you know this?
10. The writer says in this para that Birsa fought against three things. What are they ?
11. A lot of people became Birsa's followers. What qualities of Birsa could have attracted them towards him?
12. Why did the British Government join hands with the money-lenders and the land lords?
13. Who fought against the followers of Birsa?
14. Where was the British force defeated by Birsa and his followers?
What would happen to Birsa and his followers? Will they be rewarded or punished ? Read the next part and see.

Session - 3

SGP-3

- Read the paragraph-3 and 4 silently and answer the questions that follow:

3. Birsa's movement became a movement against the British Government. In one of the battles at Dumari Hill, near Ranchi hundreds of innocent tribals including women and children were killed. But the police failed to arrest Birsa. For about four years Birsa continued his fight against the Government without getting arrested. So the Government declared rewards to capture Birsa.
4. Learned about the reward, nine persons of Jerkel village searched for Birsa. One day, deep at night they captured Birsa while he was sleeping inside a small hut in a forest. By that time Birsa was tired of running from place to place and was not in good health. He was handed over to the police at Ranchi where hundreds of his followers gathered. While he was taken to the prison, he told to his followers in tearful eyes, "Do not feel disappointed. Do not think I am running away leaving you behind. Do not think our fight has come to an end. We'll continue our fight till we die".

Comprehension Questions

1. What is the third para about ?
2. Why did the British Government get angry with Birsa?
3. Which battle was very painful for Birsa?
4. What happened in this battle at Dhumari hill?
5. Was Birsa arrested in this battle? What did he do?
6. What did the Government declare for Birsa's capture?
7. Who helped the Britishers to arrest Birsa?
8. Where and when did the British army arrest Birsa?
9. Who does 'they' in the second sentence in para-4 refer to?
10. Were the persons of Jerkel village right to help the Britishers to arrest Birsa ?
11. Where was Birsa handed over to the police?
12. What happened when he was handed over to the police?
13. What did Birsa tell his followers?
14. Which words of Birsa do you like most ?

Will the Britishers make Birsa free from jail ? Let's read the last part and see.

SGP-4

● Read the paragraph-5 silently and answer the questions that follow:

5. Later it was said that Birsa died of cholera in Ranchi Jail on 30th May, 1900. But it was suspected by many that he was poisoned. Thus ended the life of the greatest of tribal heroes. Birsa died more than hundred years ago. But he still lives in our memory. The Government of India and many state governments have named many institutes such as Birsa Munda Airport, Birsa Institute of Technical Education etc. after him. A university, 'Birsa Agricultural University' is named after him. The Government of India has also produced a documentary film on Birsa Munda

Comprehension Questions

1. What does the writer talk about Birsa Munda in the last paragraph ?
2. What was said about Birsa's death ?
3. Do all the people believe it ?
4. What do many people suspect ?
5. The writer says that after 100 years of Birsa's death, 'he still lives in our memory'. Why does he say so ?
6. What have the Government of India and many other state governments done in the memory of Birsa Munda ?
7. Which quality of Birsa Munda do you like most ?
8. How many years did Birsa Munda live ?
9. Can you tell some names of freedom fighters of Odisha who have sacrificed their lives for our motherland ?

II Post-reading

1 Visual Memory Development Technique (VMDT) :

- (a) Whole Text : Birsa's birth year-1875, battle of Khunti, reading a book, died of cholera, evil spirit, village quack, battle of Dhumari hill, The police failed to arrest Birsa, Birsa was taken into prison
- (b) Part-text : Para-4- Jerkel village, a small hut, the police at Ranchi, "Don't feel disappointed. We'll continue our fight till we die."

2 Comprehension Activities:

- (a) Complete the following sentences choosing the most appropriate alternatives from the options.
- (i) Birsa Munda was born in the year _____ .
(A) 1875 (C) 1857
(B) 1900 (D) 1885
- (ii) He worked as a cow-boy because _____ .
(A) his father was cruel
(B) his family was poor
(C) he did not like to study
(D) he did not study well
- (iii) Birsa was fond of _____ .
(A) moving in the forest
(B) guarding cows in the jungle
(C) reading books
(D) talking to many people
- (iv) He did not obey the village quack's advice to sacrifice a goat because _____ .
(A) he believed in superstitions
(B) he did not like him
(C) the quack was a messenger of the British government
(D) he did not believe in superstitions

(v) The British force was defeated in a battle at _____.

(A) Katanga (B) Khunti (C) Ranchi (D) Jerkel

(vi) The British police killed hundreds of innocent tribals _____.

(A) at Khunti (B) at Dhumari hill (C) at Ranchi (D) at Jerkel

(b) Put the following characters in order as they are used in the text.

The landlord, Sugma Munda, The police of Ranchi, The village quack, Birsa Munda, The villagers of Jerkel

(c) Given below are some sentences about Birsa Munda. They are not in order.

Order them writing their serial numbers in brackets.

1. A village quack advised him to sacrifice a goat to cure his wound. ()
2. He worked as a cowboy of a landlord from his early days. ()
3. The British rulers became his enemy. ()
4. Once his left leg was wounded while cutting wood. ()
5. He did not believe it and told people not to believe in superstition. ()
6. He fought against money lenders and policeman. ()
7. He fought against the British force in the jungle with his followers. ()
8. The British Government declared reward to capture him. ()
9. At last by the help of a man of Jarkel village, the police arrested him. ()
10. He died in Ranchi jail on 30th May 1900. ()
11. Birsa Munda was born in a poor family in 1875. ()

Session - 5

3 Listening:

- Your teacher will read aloud some of the phrases about Birsa Munda. You listen to him or her and tick those which are read aloud.

Phrases :

- born in the year 1875.
- fought with the Britishers.
- wounded while cutting wood.
- was arrested in a small hut deep in the night.
- died on 30th May 1900.
- did not obey the advice of the village quack.
- worked as a cowherd.

4 Speaking:

(a) Chain-drill:

"Birsa is dead. Long live Birsa."

(b) Dialogue Practice

[Teacher vs. students, students vs. students with change of roles]

Birsa : I have a wound on my left leg. Please give me medicine.

Quack : This wound is caused by an evil spirit.

Birsa : No Sir, I cut my leg myself.

Quack : You fool; you don't know anything, come with a goat tomorrow.

Birsa : Will a small hen do Sir ?

Quack : No.

Birsa : Why ?

Quack : The evil spirit wants a goat.

Birsa : The evil spirit or you? You yourself is a great evil spirit.

Quack : What ? (Birsa runs away.)

Session - 6

5 Vocabulary:

Match words under 'A' with the words under 'B'. Write the word numbers of 'A' in the boxes of 'B'. One is done for you. Then write them in the blank places provided below.

A	B
1. land	☒ field
2. blind	☐ quack
3. village	☐ lender
4. money	☐ hut
5. paddy	☐ tribals
6. British	☒ lord
7. Innocent	☐ Government
8. small	☐ belief

1. _____

5. Paddy _____ field

2. _____

6. _____

3. _____

7. _____

4. _____

8. _____